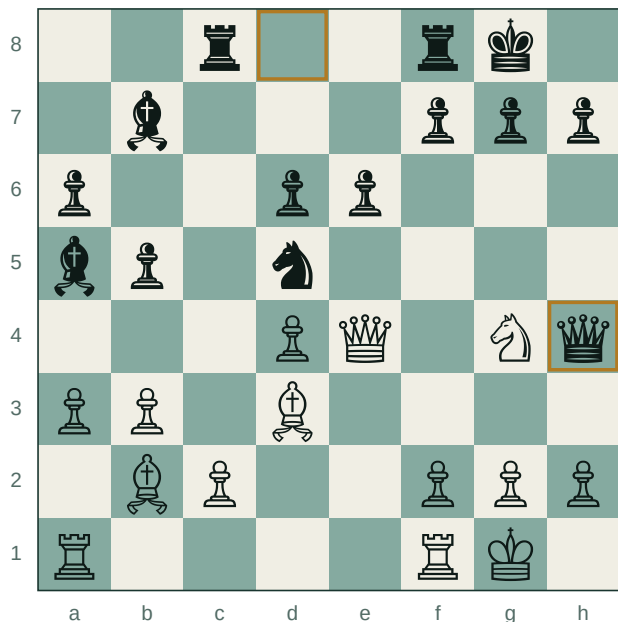


Discovered attacks: White, move 18

Discovered attacks

White to move



Previous move: 17...Qh4. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

18. Nf6+ Nxf6 19. Qxh4

18.Nf6+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on g8 and knight on d5. Recorded reply: **18...Nxf6**.

19.Qxh4 The queen captures the queen on h4.

At the end, nominal material is White 32 / Black 26 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +6. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +6: the balance goes from +0 to +6. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Choose the blocker's destination carefully. An uncovered attack may fail if the opponent has a stronger check or can capture the slider.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Moving a blocker can uncover a rook, bishop, or queen attack. The moving piece may create a second threat, giving the defender too many problems at once.

HOW TO LOOK

Find a friendly piece between a slider and an enemy target, then inspect its forcing moves and captures.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: bishop on b7 and bishop on a5. Check for tactical protection.